Steam Press



Category: **Sewing, Textile & Handicraft** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **High** 1 labs

Covers these lab items: Steam press

What it is used for

A steam press uses controlled heat, pressure, and steam to remove wrinkles and shape garments or textile materials. Correct operation improves finish quality while protecting fabric and the operator.

Main parts

- Pressing head or heated plate
- Lower pressing buck or table
- Steam supply and steam control
- Temperature and pressure controls
- Foot pedal or operating handle
- Safety guard and condensate collection system if fitted

Before you start

1. Read the operating instructions and identify the fabric's heat and steam limits.
2. Inspect the pressing surfaces, controls, hoses, guards, and power connections for damage.
3. Check the steam supply and condensate system for leaks or blockage.
4. Set the temperature and pressure suitable for the fabric and garment.
5. Ensure the pressing area is dry, clean, and free from loose objects.
6. Wear suitable protection and keep the foot pedal or controls unobstructed.

How to use

1. Switch on the machine and allow the pressing surfaces to reach the set temperature.
2. Arrange the garment smoothly on the lower buck without stretching or trapping seams.
3. Use a pressing cloth when required for delicate, dark, or heat-sensitive fabrics.
4. Keep hands clear of the pressing area and activate the press using its designated control.
5. Apply steam and pressure for the time recommended for the fabric.
6. Release the press fully before repositioning the garment.
7. Check the finish and repeat only if necessary, adjusting settings when needed.
8. Place the pressed garment on a safe surface or hanger to cool and dry.
9. Switch off the machine and isolate the power and steam supply after use.
10. Allow hot surfaces to cool before cleaning or carrying out routine maintenance.

⚠ Safety

- Keep fingers, hands, and clothing away from the closing pressing surfaces.
- Never defeat guards, two-hand controls, or other fitted safety devices.
- Do not press garments while wearing them or direct steam toward people.
- Use heat-resistant protection when handling hot fabrics or components as required.
- Report damaged hoses, electrical cables, controls, or steam leaks immediately.
- Isolate power and steam before servicing or clearing faults.

Care & storage

- Wipe pressing surfaces with approved materials after they cool.
- Inspect steam hoses, electrical cables, controls, and safety devices regularly.
- Drain or maintain the steam system according to the manufacturer's instructions.
- Keep the press clean, dry, and covered when not in use.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Using excessive heat can scorch or shrink fabric.
- Placing hands near the closing head can cause crushing or burns.
- Applying too much pressure can leave marks or damage seams.
- Ignoring steam leaks or damaged controls can create serious hazards.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.